

ALI IHSAN YAKA, Ph.D.

Clinical Psychologist

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Clinical psychologist and postdoctoral visiting scholar with 15+ years of clinical practice and humanitarian mental health and psychosocial support (MHPSS) experience. Specialized in case conceptualization, clinical supervision, and trauma in conflict and genocide contexts.

LICENSURE / CREDENTIALS

Foreign-educated doctorate evaluated by World Education Services (WES) as U.S. doctoral equivalency (course-by-course).

New York State Education Department (NYSED) (Bureau of Comparative Education): On May 22, 2026, NYSED confirmed that my Ph.D. from METU is considered the substantial equivalent, thereby satisfying Requirement 1 for licensure in New York State (NYS Education Law, Article 163). The remaining requirement is in progress.

California Board of Psychology: Not yet initiated supervised professional hours in California; prepared to begin upon employment under appropriate supervision.

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Clinical Psychology — 2024

Middle East Technical University (METU), Ankara, Turkey

Dissertation: Examining the Discourse of Mental Health Workers in Iraq: A Lacanian Approach to Social Trauma in Clinical Supervision
https://open.metu.edu.tr/handle/11511/108851

M.S., Clinical Psychology — 2012

Ankara University, Ankara, Turkey

Thesis: The Relationships Between Attachment, Early Maladaptive Schemas, Self-Regulation, and Psychological Symptoms.

B.S., Psychology — 2005

Dicle University, Diyarbakır, Turkey

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENT

Postdoctoral Visiting Scholar, Center for the Study of Psychoanalysis & Culture (CSPC), University at Buffalo (SUNY) January to August 2026

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Yaka, A. İ. (2024). Psychotic Structure, Paternal Function, and Lacanian Conceptualization. AYNA Clinical Psychology Journal, 11(1), 1–37. https://doi.org/10.31682/ayna.1282059

Yaka, A. İ. (2021). Examining the Paternal Function in Obsessional Structure from a Lacanian Perspective. AYNA Clinical Psychology Journal, 8(2), 199–220. https://doi.org/10.31682/ayna.815903

Şahin, N. H., & Yaka, A. İ. (2010). Investigating the Experiences in Close Relationships Inventory (ECR-I) in the Context of Self-Perception, Negative Automatic Thoughts and Psychopathological Symptoms. Turkish Psychological Articles, 13(26), 64–76.

PUBLIC SCHOLARSHIP

Yaka, A. İ. (2026). Ji tenêtiya psîkopatalojîk berev civakîbûna subjektîf: Tecribeya bikerbûna psîkanalîtîk. Psychology Kurdî, 9(21), 61–74.

GRANTS & AWARDS

International Psychoanalytical Association (IPA) Research Grant (2025): “How Psychoanalytic Knowledge Can Be Used in Psychosocial Field Work: Psychoanalytic Approach to Social Trauma” (12-month program).

SELECTED ACADEMIC PRESENTATIONS

Yaka, A. İ. (May 2, 2026). “Conceptualizing Êzidî Femicide as Communicide: Psychoanalytic Reflections on the Paranoiac Dimension of Language in Genocide.” CSPC Annual Symposium, The Human Outside of Language: Precarious Lives, New Clinics, University at Buffalo (SUNY), Buffalo, NY (USA).

Yaka, A. İ. (2025). “Psychoanalytic psychosocial fieldwork on Êzidî genocide: Lacanian insights into social trauma in clinical supervision.” 25th World Congress of Psychiatry (WPA), e-Poster #3015, Prague, Czech Republic (Oct 5–8).

Yaka, A. İ., & Şahin, N. H. (2011). “The relationships between attachment, early maladaptive schemas, self-regulation and psychological symptoms.” 7th International Congress of Cognitive Psychotherapy (Clinical Science), Istanbul, Turkey.

Yaka, A. İ. (2004). “Descartes’ Error and Emotional Intelligence.” 9th National Psychology Students Congress, Bursa, Turkey.

CLINICAL TRAINING (SUPERVISED)

2019–2021 — Clinical Supervisor, METU – AYNA Clinical Psychology Unit (Ankara, Turkey).

2017–2018 — Child & Adult Clinical Practicum, METU – AYNA Clinical Psychology Unit (Ankara, Turkey).

2009–2010 — Child Clinical Practicum, Ankara University School of Medicine – Dept. of Child Psychiatry & Autistic Children Center (Ankara, Turkey).

2008–2009 — Adult Clinical Practicum, Ankara University School of Medicine – Dept. of Adult Psychiatry (Ankara, Turkey).

HUMANITARIAN & INTERNATIONAL NGO EXPERIENCE (MHPSS)

2023 — Protection Officer, IsraAID – The Israeli Forum for International Humanitarian Aid (Turkey, Feb 6 Earthquakes).

2019–2020 — MHPSS Technical Advisor (Mission Order), Humanity & Inclusion / Handicap International (South Sudan).

2020–2021 — Consultant Psychotherapist/Trainer (part-time), Center for Victims of Torture (CVT) (Ninewa Plain, Iraq).

2017 — Mental Health Care Practices Program Manager (MHCP), Action Against Hunger (ACF-France) (Ninewa Plain, Iraq).

2017 — MHPSS Field Technical Advisor, Handicap International Federation (Gaziantep, Turkey).

2016 — Mental Health Officer, Médecins du Monde (MDM, France) (Êzidî Camp, Diyarbakir, Turkey).

2015 — Clinical Psychologist, Médecins Sans Frontières (MSF Holland) (Şanliurfa, Turkey).

ADDITIONAL CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

2009–2014 — Clinical Psychologist, Psychiatry Service, Ahi Evran University Education & Research Hospital (Kirsehir, Turkey).

2008–2009 — Psychologist, Ak Psycho-technical Center (Ankara, Turkey).

2007–2008 — Psychologist, The Medical Center of Disabled Children (Tekirdag, Turkey).

2005–2006 — Psychologist, The Medical Center of Deaf Children (Kocaeli, Turkey).

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE & LEADERSHIP

Reviewer, AYNA Clinical Psychology Peer-Reviewed Journal (2021–Present).

Supervisory Board Member, Freud-Lacan Psychoanalysis Association, Ankara (2021–2023).

Human Rights Association (Turkey): Executive Assembly Member, Ankara (2008–2010); volunteer member (ongoing).

SELECTED INVITED TALKS & VOLUNTEERING

Invited Speaker (Apr 27, 2025). “From Psychopathological Loneliness to Subjective Sociality: The Experience of Psychoanalytic Subjectivation.” Boğaziçi University, XI Psychology Day (Theme: Loneliness).

Guest Speaker (Oct 22, 2024). “Case Conceptualization in Clinical Psychoanalysis.” GİPDER (Entrepreneurial Psychologists Association), live streamed on YouTube.

Volunteer Clinical Psychologist (Feb–Apr 2023). Earthquake Relief Response (Hatay & Kahramanmaraş, Turkey): crisis interventions and psychosocial support in coordination with local communities and civil society.

CERTIFICATIONS & CONTINUING EDUCATION

APsA 2026 National Meeting (New York, NY): 44.5 Continuing Education credits (APA CE for Psychologists), Jan 27–Feb 1, 2026.

Trust & Safety Advanced Practitioner Certificate (Intellect Certified) completed Mar 25, 2025 (Credential ID: 67e19cc36809a9cf6e0f60a6).

Enhancing Risk Assessment Skills (Care Compass Training Program), completed Dec 16, 2024.

Advanced Training in Child Development & Psychosocial Support (Action Against Hunger), July 2017 (Erbil, Kurdistan Region of Iraq).

LANGUAGES

Kurdish (Kurmanji) — Native; Turkish — Native; English — Advanced (IELTS Academic, 2015: Overall 7.0 / CEFR C1).